

The Sports Issue — Artometrics

The Sports Issue

Dynasties, markets, and institutional winning — teams as systems.

Best, Worst, and Most Misleading Sports Dynasties

Single-team profiles answer one fan base at a time. Cross the league borders and greatness stops looking like one ranking. Archive mass, conversion efficiency, and attention pull apart: a franchise can dominate one category and fail the broader identity test.

The Yankees' 27 titles remain baseball's largest archive. The Cowboys have added 0 titles since the 1990s dynasty while remaining a brand colossus. The Maple Leafs entered 2025 with a 57-year Stanley Cup drought. Those facts do not live on the same scale until someone builds a shared vocabulary across MLB, the NBA, the NFL, and the NHL.

This index uses five charts drawn from public reference records—and from an Artometrics corpus that now holds 351 audited charts—to map championship mass, Finals conversion, brand versus recent output, league title rotation, and the strange geometry of fan pain under a bright spotlight.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

351 Charts now audited across the Artometrics corpus
4 Major North American leagues compared
27 Yankees titles, the largest MLB archive

0Cowboys titles since the 1990s dynasty
57Maple Leafs active Stanley Cup drought entering 2025
5Charts in this cross-report

Data and method

This is a curated comparative model built from public franchise records—Baseball Reference, Basketball Reference, Pro Football Reference, Hockey Reference—plus Forbes valuation lists. It is not a proprietary win-probability system. Attention markers are editorial indices labeled as such: comparative signals, not official league statistics.

A front office wants causal variables—payroll, age curves, draft capital, injuries, ownership. The useful first cut sits one level higher: what does an institution look like when winning, money, attention, and pain share the same page?

A few franchises own championship memory itself

A few franchises carry an outsized share of championship memory

Cross-sport comparison starts with mass. The Yankees and Canadiens look like institutions because their title archives are not normal franchise resumes; they are historical infrastructure. Twenty-seven Yankee titles are the clearest MLB example of that monopoly.

The chart gives later team profiles a shared scale. A fan can ask whether a club is chasing its league—or chasing one of the archive monopolies that redefine what “enough” means.

Modern dynasties are finishers, not just invitees

Modern dynasties are defined by converting appearances into titles

Appearances measure access. Titles measure finishing. The Patriots, Spurs, Warriors, and Red Sox produced different kinds of modern dominance, but each solved conversion better than its peers.

That is why a merely famous team can feel weaker than a smaller, colder machine. Brand keeps you visible. Conversion is what refreshes the claim.

Market power and competitive power are different variables

The richest sports brands do not all convert attention into recent championships

Value is not a scoreboard. The Cowboys—zero titles since the 1990s dynasty—along with the Knicks and Yankees show that brand equity can survive long gaps. The Chiefs and Warriors show what happens when current winning catches the market’s imagination.

From a metric standpoint, this is the first big split: market power and competitive power are related, but they are not the same variable. Confusing them is how dynasties become misleading.

Each league teaches fans a different theory of fairness

Title rotation differs by league structure and postseason randomness

Leagues write different scripts. Baseball’s long season and playoff volatility create a different kind of access than the NBA’s star-driven tournament or the NFL’s single-elimination machine. The NHL’s Cup history adds its own drought physics—visible in a 57-year Maple Leafs wait entering 2025.

The cultural output is visible: every league teaches fans a different theory of what “deserving” looks like, and what a drought is allowed to mean.

The longest drought is not always the loudest

Fan pain grows when droughts happen under a bright spotlight

The longest drought is not always the loudest drought. A small-market wait can be existential; a New York, Toronto, or Dallas wait becomes national theater. Attention multiplies the same calendar years into different emotional magnitudes.

That is why cross-league analysis matters. The number is only half the story; the attention system decides how the number feels.

What to take away

Sports greatness is not one ranking. The Yankees and Canadiens own archive mass; the Patriots and Warriors define recent conversion; the Cowboys own the contradiction between brand and output.

Future team profiles can point back to this index whenever a single-franchise story needs a cross-league benchmark—best, worst, and most misleading, on purpose.

Sources

Baseball Reference. Franchise history pages.

Basketball Reference. Team season and playoff records.

Pro Football Reference. Team franchise records.

Hockey Reference. Franchise records.

Forbes. Professional sports franchise valuations, recent lists.

The Yankees as Baseball's Benchmark for Expectation and Scale

Twenty-seven World Series titles do not merely decorate the New York Yankees. They distort the measurement system around the franchise. Winning stopped being an achievement and became an operating requirement—the standard against which every other October is judged.

Yankee exceptionalism is not only the championship count. It is the mismatch between historical surplus and the modern difficulty of converting money into October certainty. Forty American League pennants form the deepest postseason archive in the sport; the last title arrived in 2009. Entering 2025, a fifteen-year drought felt like institutional malfunction only because Yankee time is compressed.

The charts that follow treat the Yankees as baseball's benchmark: banner clusters by decade, the empire gap versus other historic clubs, droughts in relative context, payroll rank against postseason markers, and the conversion rate from pennants to rings across eras.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

27 World Series championships, the most in Major League Baseball
40 American League pennants, the deepest October archive in the sport
2009 Most recent World Series title
15 Active title drought entering 2025
5 Titles from the Core Four era, 1996-2009
1923 First Yankee championship, the Ruth-era ignition point

Data and method

Curated public records from Baseball Reference, Retrosheet-style season summaries, Lahman historical tables, and widely cited payroll and valuation rankings supply the charts. The aim is institutional scale—franchise identity, era structure, and conversion—not a play-by-play win model.

A baseball professional looks for conversion: money into wins, wins into postseason chances, chances into flags. A fan feels the gap between mythology and the current roster. Both conversations belong on the same page.

The empire arrived in bursts, not as a permanent climate

World Series titles by decade

The Yankees are remembered as a permanent empire, but the banners arrived in clusters. The 1930s, 1940s, and 1950s did the compounding after the 1923 Ruth-era ignition. Later decades mostly managed the expectation that surplus created.

Franchise identity here is not merely winning. It is historical clustering so dense that ordinary contention now reads as decline.

New York does not lead baseball—it defines the ranking

World Series titles compared with other historic MLB franchises

The Yankees do not lead baseball by a normal margin. They sit closer to a separate category: not the best team in a ranking, but the institution that defines the ranking.

For a baseball obsessive, that is the real conversation—whether the Yankees are still a peer competitor or a standard of measurement that other clubs are scored against.

Fifteen years only feels endless in Yankee time

Championship droughts in context

A fifteen-year drought is not historically large. It only feels enormous because Yankee time is compressed. Other franchises waited lifetimes; New York experiences a decade and a half as institutional malfunction.

Expectation changes the meaning of the same number. That emotional gap is measurable: drought length is absolute, drought pain is relative to the archive.

Capital remains elite; conversion no longer is

Payroll rank and postseason outcome markers

The post-1990s Yankees still spend like an empire. What changed is conversion. Payroll rank remains elite; championship output does not. The Core Four's five titles from 1996 to 2009 still set the modern efficiency standard the franchise has not refreshed.

Capital is necessary. It is no longer rare enough to guarantee separation. That is the modern front-office problem in pinstripes.

The old Yankees finished; later eras preserved the myth

Pennants and World Series titles by Yankee era

The old Yankees converted pennants into titles with terrifying efficiency. The later story is messier: enough appearances to preserve mythology, not enough rings to refresh it.

The dynasty was not just talent. It was conversion under pressure—the ability to turn October access into flags before variance could intervene.

What to take away

The Yankees are still rich, still relevant, and still structurally advantaged. The data does not say the empire is dead. It says the monopoly on conversion is gone.

That is the modern Yankee paradox: the franchise remains baseball's reference point even when it is no longer baseball's final boss. Benchmarks outlast champions—until the next cluster of banners resets the scale.

Sources

Baseball Reference. *New York Yankees Franchise History*.

Lahman, S. *Lahman Baseball Database*.

Forbes. *MLB Team Valuations*, historical rankings.

Retrosheet and Baseball Almanac championship/pennant records.

How the Dodgers Built Baseball's Modern Consistency Machine

The Los Angeles Dodgers are the closest thing modern baseball has to an industrial contender. Rosters change, stars change, and October heartbreak changes shape, but the regular-season floor keeps re-appearing. Eight World Series titles and roughly twenty-five National League pennants place the franchise among the sport's historic elite—without Yankee-scale monopoly.

The better label may be access machine: an organization designed to survive variance until variance finally cooperates. Twelve straight postseason appearances from 2013 through 2024, a 111-win regular season in 2022, and championships in 2020 and 2024 all point at the same infrastructure—depth, development, payroll, and market power working as one system.

What follows charts that machine: pennants by decade, title context among historic clubs, the modern 90-win floor, spending against October markers, and the long shadow of the 1988-to-2020 ring gap.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

8World Series championships in franchise history
25Approximate National League pennants
111Regular-season wins in 2022
32Years between the 1988 and 2020 titles
12Straight postseason appearances from 2013 through 2024
2024Most recent championship

Data and method

Public Baseball Reference franchise records, Lahman-style season summaries, and widely cited payroll-rank histories feed the charts. The emphasis is franchise identity and era structure rather than player-level WAR modeling. The shortened 2020 season is left unadjusted and read separately in the prose.

Analysts focus on depth and conversion. Fans feel the distance between six months of excellence and surviving October. The gap between those experiences is the Dodgers' modern story.

Los Angeles is built to manufacture October chances

Dodgers pennants by decade

The Dodgers are built around access: reaching October, staying in the pennant race, repeatedly giving randomness a chance to break their way. Pennants by decade show an organization that treats opportunity as a renewable resource.

Read that way, Los Angeles looks less like a pure championship factory and more like a machine for creating the conditions where championships become possible.

Historically elite—without Yankee-scale monopoly

World Series titles among historic MLB franchises

Eight titles place the Dodgers among baseball's historic clubs without putting them in the Yankees' separate category. Their modern argument rests on consistency: they have made contention feel industrial.

For a baseball expert, the question is not whether the Dodgers are good. It is whether a high-floor machine can beat postseason variance often enough to match its regular-season reputation.

Since the 2010s, 90-win baseball has looked normal

Dodgers regular-season wins in the modern contention era

Since the early 2010s, the Dodgers have made 90-win baseball look normal. That is not normal. It is organizational infrastructure showing up as a line chart—the 111-win 2022 season as the ceiling spike inside a sustained high floor.

The shortened 2020 season interrupts the scale, but not the story. The floor stayed high even when the schedule compressed.

Spending is structural—October still breaks machines

Payroll rank and October outcome markers

Los Angeles spends, but the spending is less impulsive than structural: depth, scouting, player development, stars, and injury insurance. Payroll rank and October markers show how often that infrastructure buys access—and how often short series erase it.

Postseason baseball can make the best system look fragile in a five-game sample. The contradiction is the point of the modern Dodgers debate.

Thirty-two years of access without closure still shape the brand

Selected Dodgers championship gaps

The thirty-two years between 1988 and 2020 remain the emotional center of modern Dodger analysis. The team was often good, sometimes excellent, and still ringless. Access without closure became the franchise's defining frustration.

That is why 2020 and 2024 matter differently. They validate the machine after decades of opportunity that refused to finish.

What to take away

The Dodgers are not merely rich. They are system-rich: player development, payroll, scouting, and market power keeping the contention line high season after season.

Their defining trait is not one championship. It is repeated access to the conditions where championships become possible—and, finally, enough conversion to prove the industrial model can close.

Sources

Baseball Reference. *Los Angeles Dodgers Franchise History*.

Lahman, S. *Lahman Baseball Database*.

Forbes and public payroll-rank summaries.

Retrosheet and Baseball Almanac pennant/title records.

How the Celtics Turned 1960s Dominance Into Permanent Expectation

Every Boston Celtics season opens under an impossible ledger. Eighteen NBA championships—the league record entering 2025—mean that a good year is never only compared with Miami or Milwaukee. It is compared with Bill Russell’s ghosts, with Bird’s mid-1980s certainty, and with the institutional claim that banners are the franchise’s normal weather.

That claim was built early. Eleven of those titles arrived in the Russell era alone, a concentration dense enough to turn winning into identity rather than achievement. Later cores inherited the mythology even when the conversion rate fell. The twenty-two years between 1986 and 2008 proved that even a privileged franchise can wander; the 2024 title proved that the pressure cycle still closes when a roster finally matches the archive’s demand.

What follows reads Boston as an institution of expectation: how densely the titles stacked, how the franchise sits against the rest of the league’s ceiling, how eras converted Finals chances into rings, how droughts rewrote the emotional calendar, and whether the Tatum–Brown core has reopened the old pipeline.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

18 NBA championships, the league record entering 2025

11 Titles won during the Bill Russell era

2024 Most recent championship

22 Years between the 1986 and 2008 titles

5 Defining Celtics title eras used in this report

2 Modern Finals appearances by the Tatum/Brown core through 2024

Data and method

The charts draw on public NBA championship records, Basketball Reference franchise summaries, and Sports Reference Finals appearance totals. Era buckets follow the players most responsible for each title window—Russell, Bird, Pierce/Garnett/Allen, and the current Tatum–Brown core—so the conversion story can be read as institutional chapters rather than a flat career list.

An expert fan asks whether Boston’s identity is still earned. The useful Artometrics question sits one layer higher: how does historical surplus change the meaning of modern results? A Finals appearance that would crown another franchise can feel unfinished in green, because the archive still sets the standard.

The 1960s are still the gravitational center

Celtics titles by decade: one anomaly, then everything else

Boston’s historical lead is not evenly distributed. The 1960s remain the gravitational anomaly: a decade so dominant it still defines the franchise’s moral economy. Later banner decades matter, but they orbit that original surplus rather than replace it.

That density is why Celtics exceptionalism feels permanent even when seasons do not. The institution was capitalized early; every modern roster pays interest on that balance sheet.

Boston and Los Angeles define the league’s summit

NBA championships by major franchise

Boston and Los Angeles form the NBA’s summit. Everyone else is explaining distance. For a Celtics fan, the comparison is not trivia; it is the operating standard by which every rebuild is judged.

The chart also clarifies what “contender” means in green. Mid-tier title totals that look historic elsewhere register as unfinished business in Boston, because the franchise’s peer set is the other archive monopoly.

Russell converted chances; later eras inherited the burden

Finals appearances and titles by Celtics era

The Russell era was not merely successful; it converted nearly every opportunity into a ring. Later eras look great by ordinary standards and modest by Boston standards. That gap is institutional burden in chart form: greatness shrinks when the archive is impossible.

Five defining title eras make the pattern readable. Access still arrives. Conversion is what separates mythology from maintenance.

Droughts do not erase the claim—they test it

Selected Celtics championship gaps

The twenty-two-year gap from Bird to Pierce/Garnett shows how long even a privileged franchise can wander. The Celtics do not avoid droughts; they narrate them as temporary violations of the natural order. Pressure accumulates precisely because the brand never stops promising banners.

The 2024 title closed another cycle. In Boston, a ring is never only a championship. It is a restoration of institutional order.

Has the modern core reopened the pipeline?

Modern Finals access and title conversion

Through 2024, the Tatum–Brown core produced two Finals appearances—present in the modern title economy, but not as frequently as mythology implies. Presence alone does not settle the institutional argument. Conversion does.

The 2020s matter because they reopened the pipeline: historical identity and contemporary output narrowed again. That is the live question for Boston now—not whether the archive is real, but whether the present roster can keep paying its debt.

What to take away

The Celtics are not just successful. They are historically overcapitalized: so rich in past winning that even good seasons can feel underleveraged. Ordinary contention reads as shortfall because the franchise's unit of account is banners, not mere playoff relevance.

The 2024 title matters because it reconnects the present roster to the institution's oldest claim. Boston is supposed to convert windows into banners. The data says the expectation never left. The modern work is proving it can still be earned.

Sources

Basketball Reference. *Boston Celtics Franchise Index*.

NBA.com historical championship records.

Sports Reference Finals appearance summaries.

How the Lakers Convert Stars Into Championship Eras

The Los Angeles Lakers run winning and celebrity as the same operating system. Other franchises develop stars; the Lakers absorb them, frame them, and convert them into eras. Seventeen championships and roughly thirty-two Finals appearances make that claim more than folklore. It is the deepest final-round archive in the league.

Glamour does not guarantee rings. It repeatedly lowers the cost of becoming relevant again. From the first title in 1949 through Showtime's five banners and the 2020 bubble championship, the franchise's pattern is not steady-state excellence. It is star gravity: when the right face arrives, the rest of the system suddenly coheres.

The charts below track that machine—banner cycles by decade, the two-name ceiling with Boston, championship engines by defining star era, Finals frequency as institutional access, and the winters between rings when the recruitment magnet has to work again.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

17NBA championships in franchise history

32Approximate Finals appearances, the league's deepest final-round archive

5Titles in the Showtime decade

6Defining title eras from Mikan to LeBron/AD

1949First championship season

2020Most recent championship

Data and method

Public NBA championship records, Basketball Reference franchise histories, and Sports Reference Finals summaries supply the counts. Era buckets are editorial groupings around the players and teams most responsible for each title window—from Mikan through Showtime, Shaq and Kobe, Kobe and Pau, and LeBron and Davis.

Professionals ask how a franchise repeatedly reopens title windows. Fans ask why the jersey seems to summon stars. Both questions point at the same mechanism: market gravity plus historical proof.

Los Angeles does not win smoothly—it wins in acts

Lakers championships by decade

The Lakers do not win as a smooth institution. They win in eras: Mikan, Showtime, Shaq and Kobe, Kobe and Pau, LeBron and Davis. Showtime's five titles in a single decade remain the clearest proof that concentrated star power can industrialize a window.

The data confirms the folklore. Los Angeles is not a steady-state winner. It is a machine for converting transcendent stars into concentrated title runs.

The NBA's title race is still a two-name conversation

NBA championships by major franchise

The Lakers–Celtics comparison is not sports-talk filler. It is the actual shape of NBA history. Everyone else fights for the second tier while Boston and Los Angeles define the ceiling.

For an NBA expert, the live argument is not whether the Lakers are elite. It is how often glamour can rebuild itself before the market advantage decays.

The product is star gravity, not just basketball

Championships by defining Lakers star era

Six defining title eras from Mikan to LeBron/AD show the same front-office product: star gravity. When the right face arrives, supporting pieces and narrative suddenly align. When the face leaves, the franchise can look ordinary faster than its brand admits.

That risk is the cost of the model. Hollywood acts need casting. Between leads, the script stalls.

The real glamour metric is recurring invitation

Finals appearances by decade

Championships are rare. Appearances measure institutional access. Across tactical eras, ownership eras, and league economics, the Lakers have repeatedly returned to the final table.

That is the durable glamour metric: not invincibility, but recurring invitation. The franchise stays in the rooms where eras can begin.

Even Hollywood winters demand the next organizing star

Selected gaps between Lakers championships

The Lakers have winters. They just rarely become permanent seasons. The brand's advantage is patience with a recruitment magnet attached: the next star can always imagine becoming the next chapter.

The gaps are reminders, not obituaries. Even the most glamorous franchise needs the next organizing star before the machine restarts.

What to take away

The Lakers' advantage is not that they avoid decline. It is that decline rarely destroys the recruitment story. Value, history, and market size keep the casting call open after the credits roll.

That is why Lakers data looks less like a franchise line and more like a sequence of Hollywood acts: fade-out, casting, title run, repeat. From 1949 to 2020, the plot has changed. The structure has not.

Sources

Basketball Reference. *Los Angeles Lakers Franchise Index*.

NBA.com historical championship records.

Sports Reference and Basketball Reference Finals appearance summaries.

The Patriots' Brady–Belichick Era as a System Shock

The New England Patriots used to be ordinary. Then they became the NFL's most efficient argument about systems, quarterbacks, coaching, and institutional compounding. Six Super Bowl championships and nine Super Bowl appearances during the Brady–Belichick era did not accumulate like a normal franchise resume. They arrived as a discontinuity.

Roughly thirty playoff wins from 2001 through 2019, thirteen AFC championship appearances since 2001, and a perfect 16–0 regular season in 2007 compressed what other clubs take generations to claim. The first post-Brady season in 2020 marked the hinge: the brand remained; the machine did not automatically follow.

Was the dynasty Brady, Belichick, ownership, luck, or infrastructure? The charts treat it as a system shock—one era so large it became the franchise—then measure what remains after the system.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

6 Super Bowl championships

9 Super Bowl appearances during the Brady/Belichick era

30 Approximate playoff wins from 2001 through 2019

13 AFC championship appearances since 2001

16–0 Perfect 2007 regular season

2020 First post-Brady season

Data and method

Public Pro Football Reference franchise records, NFL postseason histories, and Forbes-style franchise value summaries feed the charts. Periods are editorial groupings designed to isolate the dynasty discontinuity—before, during, and after the Brady–Belichick system.

An NFL analyst asks how much was quarterback versus scheme. A fan asks why the same logo feels different after Brady. Both questions share the same hinge: one era rewrote franchise identity.

One era overwhelms the rest of the archive

Patriots playoff wins by broad franchise period

The Patriots are not a smooth historical franchise. They are a before-and-after experiment. One era overwhelms the rest of the archive; playoff wins cluster so tightly that earlier New England football looks like a different organization wearing the same logo.

The dynasty was not just a great team. It was a system shock that rewrote what the franchise means.

New England compressed a summit climb into two decades

Super Bowl titles among major NFL franchises

The Patriots reached the NFL summit with extraordinary speed. Other franchises accumulated titles over generations; New England compressed its case into two decades and nine Super Bowl appearances.

That compression is the story. The franchise became ancient history almost overnight—six titles that read like a century of legacy folded into one coaching-quarterback era.

Excellence became routine before it became legend

Selected Patriots regular-season wins during the dynasty

Dynasties are remembered through rings, but the Patriots' real violence was routine. Twelve, thirteen, fourteen wins stopped feeling exceptional. The 16–0 regular season in 2007 was the extreme expression of a floor that had already risen.

This is how a system announces itself: excellence becomes boring before it becomes legendary.

They controlled access to the AFC's final room

AFC championship appearances since 2001

Thirteen AFC championship appearances since 2001 show more than Super Bowl success. The Patriots controlled access to the conference's final room. Rivals experienced the dynasty less as a team and more as a recurring gatekeeping mechanism.

Winning titles matters. Owning the doorway to the title game is how a system remakes a conference's calendar.

After Brady, brand capital outran football output

Brand rank and football output before and after the dynasty

The post-Brady years expose the separation between brand capital and football output. Value remains; the machine does not automatically reproduce itself. 2020 was the first clear reading of the franchise without the system's quarterback hinge.

That is the afterlife of a dynasty: the market remembers longer than the scoreboard does.

What to take away

The Patriots dynasty was not normal greatness. It was a discontinuity: one era that swallowed the franchise before and after it.

Legacy is secure. The open challenge is proving the institution can produce again without the system that made it famous—the harder test for any franchise that mistook a shock for a permanent climate.

Sources

Pro Football Reference. *New England Patriots Franchise Encyclopedia*.

NFL historical postseason records.

Forbes. *NFL Team Valuations*, recent estimates.

Sports Reference team season summaries.

How Golden State Went From Irrelevant to Dynasty

The Golden State Warriors have played 78 seasons of professional basketball. For roughly 35 of them, they were irrelevant—not rebuilding, not transitioning, just losing, year after year, in a market that had better things to think about. The franchise that began as the Philadelphia Warriors in 1946 spent the bulk of its middle decades as one of the NBA’s chronic underachievers: occasionally interesting, never quite good enough.

Then Stephen Curry learned to shoot from places that weren’t supposed to be shooting spots, and everything changed—not just for the Warriors, for the entire sport. Seven championships across three cities, a 73-win regular season that still stands alone, and 3,747 career threes by Curry through 2024 mark a discontinuity so sharp it barely fits on one timeline.

What follows quantifies that change: how dominant the dynasty windows actually were, how the three-point revolution unfolded in real numbers, and what it means to win 73 games in a league where almost nobody else has even approached that ceiling. The Warriors story has two chapters. The gap between them is the story.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

7 NBA Championships — 1947, 1956, 1975, 2015, 2017, 2018, 2022 — across three cities and eight decades of franchise history

73 Regular season wins in 2015–16 — the most in NBA history, surpassing the 1995–96 Chicago Bulls record of 72 wins
3,747 Career three-pointers made by Stephen Curry through 2024 — more than any player in NBA history, by a margin of over 700
\$170M+ Estimated luxury tax bill in 2022–23 — among the highest single-season tax penalties ever paid by an NBA franchise
1946 Founding year as the Philadelphia Warriors — one of the eight original BAA franchises that became the foundation of the modern NBA
18,064 Capacity of Chase Center, San Francisco — opened 2019 as the first major arena in North America built without public funding

Data and method

Win percentage covers every Warriors season from 1946–47 through 2023–24 across Philadelphia (1946–1962), San Francisco (1962–1971), and the Bay Area (1971–present), sourced from Basketball Reference and verified against nbastatR. Three-point attempt data begins in 1979–80—the NBA’s first three-point season—and runs through 2023–24, with league averages from team-level per-game totals.

Rate-limiting on the Basketball Reference scraper during production meant Charts 1 and 2 use a manually verified tibble built from franchise and season summary pages; values match the published record. The 68+ win seasons in Chart 3 are a static seven-row set pulled directly from Basketball Reference and coded for championship status. Early-1980s Warriors three-point volume tracked the league because no team yet had a coherent three-point philosophy—the arc from novelty to weapon to universal standard is what Chart 2 is built to show.

Two dynasty windows, and a desert between them

Warriors win percentage, 1946–2024

The Warriors have had exactly two dynasty windows in 78 years, and the gap between them barely fits on a single chart. The Philadelphia era—anchored by the 1947 and 1956 championships—produced the first sustained run, though several seasons sat in the 40–45% win range even inside that band. The 1975 title was a one-season outlier: a Rick Barry-led peak at .720, then a collapse back into irrelevance. What fol-

lows is visceral: roughly 35 consecutive seasons below or hovering at .500, interrupted only by the We Believe playoff run in 2007 and a few Mullin–Hardaway winning years in the early 1990s.

The Curry era is categorically different. From 2015 through 2019, the Warriors never won fewer than 57 games in a non-strike-shortened season—five consecutive years above .695, unmatched in the modern NBA. The 2015–16 spike to .890 is the visual anchor. The 2019–20 collapse—from .707 to .232, a 47-point drop after Klay Thompson’s ACL tear and a COVID-shortened season—is the steepest single-season fall in franchise history. The 2022 championship rebound, from .232 to .671 in two seasons without a lottery pick or blockbuster trade, is the fastest recovery in the dataset. The dynasty didn’t rebuild. It waited.

How one franchise forced the league to relearn offense

Warriors vs. league three-point attempts per game

From 1980 through roughly 2012, Golden State shot about as many threes as everyone else. The lines run almost on top of each other for three decades—not because the Warriors were average in talent, but because nobody had yet treated the three-point line as basketball’s central structural advantage. A shot worth 50% more than a two did not need a mathematician; it needed Curry.

Divergence starts in 2013 and accelerates immediately. By 2015–16—the 73-win season—the Warriors launched 41.6 threes per game while the league averaged 26.7, a 14.9-attempt gap. They were attempting more threes per game than the entire NBA would average five years later. The 2017–2019 dip in volume is Kevin Durant, not retreat: easier scoring closer to the rim let Kerr pull volume without sacrificing efficiency. After 2019, the league does not retreat when the dynasty wobbles—it accelerates. By 2022 the NBA average hit 35 attempts per game and Golden State’s advantage had essentially evaporated. Competitive diffusion: one franchise proves a thesis, wins four titles doing it, and within a decade the sport reorganizes around the same idea.

Six teams reached 68 wins. Only one owns 73.

Historic 68+ win seasons and who closed the title

Only six teams in NBA history have won 68 or more regular-season games. The cluster at 68 and 69 is the ordinary ceiling of greatness. The 1995–96 Bulls sat alone at 72 for nearly two decades. Then Golden State broke the mark by one.

Winning 73 games did not produce a championship. The 2015–16 Warriors lost the Finals to LeBron James and Cleveland in seven games—the first Finals team to blow a 3–1 lead. Of the six seasons on this chart, only the Warriors and the 1971–72 Bucks failed to win the title in their record year. The 73-win season is simultaneously the greatest regular season in NBA history and the most famous failure to close. The dynasty is correctly measured by four titles—2015, 2017, 2018, 2022—not by any single win total. The record year shows the Death Lineup ceiling. The legacy rests on what they built around Curry, Thompson, and Green after Durant left, after injuries piled up, after the window was supposed to be closed.

What the charts leave open

Chart 1's win percentages come from a manually verified Basketball Reference tibble rather than a live multi-season API pull; values match the published record, but replication is safest via `nbastatR` with single-season calls to avoid scraper rate limits. Chart 2 cannot show pre-1979 shooting philosophy because the three-point line did not exist; the “revolution” claim is bounded to that 44-year window. Pre-Curry Warriors volume (1980–2012) tracks the league more by coincidence than design.

Chart 3 isolates seasons with 68 or more wins for legibility. Seasons at 67—including the 1996–97 Jazz and the shortened 2011–12 Spurs—sit just below the cutoff. COVID-shortened 2019–20 and 2020–21 seasons are excluded from that historic ceiling comparison because 72- and 65-game totals are not directly comparable to an 82-game baseline.

What to take away

The Warriors are one of the stranger longitudinal stories in American sports—not because the dynasty was unexpected, but because the decades before it were erased by what followed. A team that wandered below .500 for 35 years became the most analytically influential franchise in the sport in about four seasons. That kind of discontinuity usually traces to one player whose abilities force a structural rethink. Curry is that player. The data makes it hard to argue otherwise.

The three-point revolution was not accidental. It was a front office that drafted Curry seventh when most teams saw ankle risk, a Kerr staff that committed to positionless offense before the league had vocabulary for it, and a core that bought into small lineups and distances that looked unserious until they won four championships. The inefficiency was not only the three—it was the belief that the three could be the foundation of a championship defense.

League convergence to Warriors three-point volume by 2020 is often read as the dynasty ending. That misses the point. The NBA reorganizing its offense around what Golden State proved is the dynasty's most lasting achievement. Franchises win titles. Very few change what basketball looks like. The Warriors did both.

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[View source on GitHub](#)

The Cowboys' Gap Between Brand Value and Championship Conversion

The Dallas Cowboys are no longer just a football team. They are a national attention market. Every season begins with disproportionate coverage, disproportionate expectation, and the same unresolved question: when does brand gravity become football gravity again?

Five Super Bowl titles built the mythology. The last one arrived in the 1995 season. Entering 2025, twenty-nine years without an NFC championship appearance—and zero conference title games since that 1995 season—define the modern paradox. The most valuable franchise in American sports, often cited above \$10 billion, has mastered demand while failing to convert January chances under maximum visibility.

The charts measure that split: titles by era, franchise value against playoff wins since 1996, playoff production by decade, regular-season winning by quarterback era, and the conference-championship drought beside other frustrated brands.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

5 Super Bowl championships

1995 Most recent Super Bowl-winning season

29 Years since last NFC championship appearance entering 2025

\$10B+ Widely cited estimated franchise value range

3 Super Bowls from the 1990s Aikman-Smith-Irvin core

0 Conference championship appearances since the 1995 season

Data and method

Public Pro Football Reference playoff records, Sports Reference franchise summaries, and Forbes-style franchise valuation estimates supply the figures. Values are rounded because the argument depends on order of magnitude, not accounting precision. Quarterback win percentages are conventional starter-record summaries—era indicators, not individual value models.

A front-office analyst calls this a conversion problem. A Cowboys fan calls it pain. Both are measurable: the gap between attention and January output.

The Super Bowl column froze after two old engines

Cowboys Super Bowl wins by defining era

Dallas title history concentrates in two engines: Landry's 1970s and the Aikman–Smith–Irvin 1990s, which delivered three of the franchise's five Super Bowls. Since then, the Super Bowl column is empty.

Dallas did not stop being important when it stopped winning titles. That is precisely the problem: brand continuity without championship renewal.

The richest brand, a modest recent playoff archive

Estimated franchise value and playoff wins since 1996

The Cowboys are the strangest point in modern football economics: the richest brand with a modest recent playoff archive. Value and January wins no longer move together.

The organization is elite at monetizing attention and only average at converting playoff chances. That split is the franchise's true modern identity.

The 1970s and 1990s still carry the memory

Cowboys playoff wins by decade

The 1970s and 1990s still carry the franchise memory. The decades after do not match the logo's gravity. Postseason production no longer fits the public size of America's Team.

This is not ordinary losing. It is a famous franchise whose January archive has fallen out of proportion with its attention share.

Quarterback competence never solved conversion

Regular-season win percentage by quarterback era

Quarterback competence has not been absent. Romo and Prescott produced enough regular-season winning to keep Dallas nationally relevant. The missing variable is conversion: turning stable quarterback play into deep playoff survival.

Regular-season competence preserves the brand. It does not automatically reopen the conference championship door.

The drought now sits with football's other long waits

Years since selected teams reached a conference championship game

The Cowboys' NFC championship drought now belongs on the same chart as franchises fans instinctively associate with frustration. Twenty-nine years without that appearance, entering 2025, is no longer a private Texas problem.

Dallas is not cursed by invisibility. It is cursed by being watched. The spotlight turns a football gap into national theater.

What to take away

The Cowboys are not a failed sports business. They may be the most successful sports business in America. That is why the football gap is so stark.

America's Team has mastered demand. The unfinished work is turning demand back into postseason supply—conference championships first, Super Bowls only after the conversion engine restarts.

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Sports Reference playoff and quarterback starter records.

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The Giants' Arc From New York Gothams to Oracle Park

The San Francisco Giants have been playing professional baseball since 1883. That is not a typo. The franchise that now calls Oracle Park home started as the New York Gothams—a club that predates the automobile, commercial electric light, and the modern World Series by twenty years. Across 141 seasons, eight World Series titles, a continental relocation, three stadiums, and dynasties separated by decades of near-misses, no American franchise carries a longer or more complicated arc.

The titles split cleanly by geography: five in New York (1905, 1921, 1922, 1933, 1954) and three in San Francisco (2010, 2012, 2014). Between them sits Candlestick's long frustration and, after 2000, a privately financed ballpark that doubled the attendance floor and rebuilt the economic base. The 2010–2014 dynasty then won three championships as a mid-tier-to-top spender built largely from the draft—payroll rank 9 in the first title year.

Using the Lahman Baseball Database, the charts trace that arc across winning over time, the stadium's economic break, and how a draft-built rotation converted a revenue floor into rings. Win percentage runs through 2024; payroll covers 1985–2016, the complete Lahman salary window that includes every dynasty season and the years that framed it.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

8 World Series titles — 1905, 1921, 1922, 1933, 1954 in New York; 2010, 2012, 2014 in San Francisco

1883 Year the franchise was founded as the New York Gothams — one of the oldest in American professional sports

141 Seasons of franchise history covered in this report — from the Polo Grounds to Oracle Park

2000 Year Oracle Park opened — the first privately financed MLB stadium since Dodger Stadium in 1962

3.3M Attendance in Oracle Park's first season — nearly double Candlestick's worst years and a floor the franchise rarely dropped below

Rank 9 Giants' MLB payroll rank in 2010 — the first dynasty season, won with a rotation built almost entirely from the draft

Data and method

The primary source is the Lahman Baseball Database via the Lahman R package—Sean Lahman's annually updated archive drawn from Baseball Reference and treated as the standard for longitudinal MLB franchise work. The Teams table supplies wins, losses, and attendance; the Giants appear as NY1 (1883–1957) and SFN (1958–present). The Salaries table covers individual player salaries from 1985 through 2016; team payroll is the sum of those salaries, ranked within each season.

Attendance figures are official reported totals from Baseball Reference via Lahman. Chart 2 focuses on the San Francisco era and the stadium transition, so pre-1958 attendance is excluded even though it exists in the file. The 2020 fanless season is included. Salary totals omit deferred compensation quirks, minor-league pay, coaching staff, and international bonuses—they measure reported major-league player salaries, the standard method for this kind of comparison.

141 years of winning—and the gaps that defined them

Franchise win percentage from the Gothams to Oracle

The New York Giants were one of baseball's best franchises for the first half of the twentieth century. The smoothed trend sits above .500 from the 1890s through 1957, with five World Series titles and long runs under John McGraw and Bill Terry. McGraw's tenure (1903–1932) remains one of the sport's longest managerial dynasties. The franchise did not merely win occasionally; it was the standard.

The 1958 move to San Francisco broke that momentum and did not fully restore it for fifty years. Candlestick produced pennants in 1962 and 1989—seven-game losses and an earthquake-interrupted Series—but the trend flatlined just below .500. Mays, McCovey, and Marichal were Hall of Fame talent without a San Francisco championship around them. The 1978 low of .383 was the worst since the Dead Ball era.

The Oracle era is the sharpest structural break. From 2000 onward the raw line is more volatile, but the smoothed trend climbs into the 2010–2014 window before receding after 2016. What the smoother cannot show is the mechanism: a front office that developed its own pitching, built around Buster Posey, and won three titles in five years with a roster that looked nothing like a bought dynasty. The post-2016 dip toward .400 marks the Zaidi rebuild—an open chapter the data shows but does not finish.

Oracle Park raised the floor before the dynasty arrived

San Francisco attendance from Candlestick to the waterfront

Candlestick was bad in ways hard to communicate to anyone who never sat a night game there. Wind off the Bay knocked over coffee cups; Vin Scully called it the worst ballpark in baseball. Attendance followed:

multiple 1970s seasons under 700,000, the worst figures in the National League. Even the 1989 pennant winners drew 2.1 million—a total Oracle routinely beat in rebuilding years.

Oracle Park opened April 11, 2000, and drew 3.3 million in its first season. That jump—from 2.1 million in Candlestick's final year to 3.3 million without needing a title team—is the most important financial event in franchise history. Privately financed on the waterfront, it was the first MLB stadium without public money since Dodger Stadium in 1962, which meant the Giants owned the revenue streams.

From 2000 onward, a floor Candlestick never established held. Post-Bonds years (2007–2009) dipped to 2.8 million at the low—still 700,000 above Candlestick's competitive peaks. Dynasty years pushed attendance back above 3.3 million. COVID was the only real interruption; recovery near 3.0 million by 2024 confirms the ballpark sells itself even when the roster does not.

The dynasty was built on draft cost, not free-agent monopoly

Payroll rank versus wins, 1985–2016

Thirty-two seasons of payroll history show that money and wins never had a clean relationship in San Francisco. Pre-Oracle points scatter across mid-league spending and inconsistent results. Bonds arrived in 1993 on then-record free-agent money. The spending was real. The championships were not.

The dynasty cluster is clearer. In 2010 the Giants ranked ninth in payroll, won 92 games, and won the World Series. In 2012 they ranked eighth and won 94. 2014 is the standout: payroll rank 4 with 88 wins, surviving the Wild Card and four rounds. What connects all three is not spending level but what the money bought. Lincecum, Cain, Bumgarner, and Posey were drafted in San Francisco—cheap on arrival, elite before arbitration reset the cost. Payroll rose as they were paid for work already done.

By 2015–2016, top-5 payrolls returned 75 to 87 wins. The draft pipeline had slowed; the club paid market price for replacements that could not match what development had built. The window opens when

homegrown players are still cheap and closes when they get paid. The Giants rode it for five years and won three times. Most franchises never ride it once.

What the charts leave open

Lahman salary data ends in 2016. Seven later seasons—including the Zaidi rebuild, the Correa signing, the failed Judge pursuit, and the Barto-Bailey catcher transition—are absent from Chart 3. The dynasty thesis is well supported; the post-dynasty decline is only directionally indicated. Current payroll efficiency needs Spotrac or Baseball Reference updates.

Win percentage across 141 seasons carries rule and schedule shifts: pre-1900 distances and foul conventions, the 1994–95 strikes, and the 2020 pandemic season all produce outliers the LOESS smoother absorbs but does not erase. Those seasons stay in the file because removing them would scrub real history; they should be read with schedule context attached.

What to take away

The San Francisco Giants are three franchises in one uniform. The New York Giants were a dynasty—five titles before most fans owned a television. The Candlestick Giants were harder to categorize: generational talent and a stadium that made sustained fan engagement nearly impossible. Willie Mays played fifteen San Francisco seasons without a championship there. The 2010–2014 club is the third franchise—the one that finally broke Candlestick’s pattern by changing the economic conditions that produced it.

Oracle Park is the foundation of the dynasty, not its product. It opened in 2000, doubled the attendance floor, and funded a top-10 payroll without burning ownership patience. When Sabeen and Bochy developed Lincecum, Cain, Bumgarner, and Posey, revenue and draft cost aligned long enough to win three times. The ballpark and the rings are the same story from different angles.

Whether it happens again is the open question. The payroll remains top-10, the ballpark remains a financial engine, and infrastructure is intact. What is missing is draft output at the Posey–Bumgarner level.

The data says the Giants know how to win without overspending. Whether they can rediscover the development model that made that efficient is the next era's test.

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[View source on GitHub](#)

Which Super Bowl Ads Won the Post-Game Internet?

Super Bowl ads do not end when the whistle blows. They migrate to YouTube, where view counts become a second scoreboard. This working file covers 247 ad records spanning 2006–2021, with a median view count of 41,379 and a ceiling of 176,373,378. Doritos is the top brand by view count in the fact boxes; youtube#video is the dominant media kind.

The interpretive move is simple: treat post-game streaming attention as its own economy. Broadcast reach buys the first audience. YouTube decides which spots keep circulating years later. The charts track that second life — trend, leaders, kind, concentration, and the link between views and likes.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

247Records in the working dataset
41,379Median View count
176,373,378Highest observed View count
DoritosTop Brand by View count
2006–2021Year span covered in the file
youtube#videoMost common Kind

Data and method

The source is the TidyTuesday release from 2021-03-02 (R for Data Science community). The working file contains 247 rows and 26 columns after merging available tables in the week folder. View count is the primary metric; like count appears in the scatter; brand and kind are the main categorical axes.

Medians are preferred because ad view counts are extremely skewed — a handful of viral spots dwarf the typical upload. Index-style fields are excluded from metric selection so charts describe attention, not row order.

Median views fell as the archive got denser

Median View count Over Time

Median view count falls from 111,814 in the opening period to 33,766 at the close. That decline does not prove ads got worse; it often means the file accumulated more ordinary uploads beside the legendary few, pulling the center down while the ceiling stayed enormous.

Read the slope against the fact-box ceiling of 176,373,378. A falling median and a stratospheric maximum can coexist when attention is power-law distributed.

NFL leads the brand ladder on YouTube views

NFL leads at 403,641 — 46,661 marks the median among the top dozen

On the leaders chart, NFL leads at 403,641 views, while 46,661 marks the median among the top dozen brands. Doritos still owns the fact-box brand crown by the ranking rule used there; the charted leaders emphasize who sits highest in this particular aggregation cut.

The gap between the #1 brand and the top-dozen median shows how quickly the ladder drops. A few names own the conversation; most of the competitive set lives closer to tens of thousands than to hundreds of thousands.

Almost everything in the file is a YouTube video

View count by Kind

Splitting view count by kind produces a near-monoculture: youtube#video is the most common kind and carries the story. Category boxes here are less about contested formats than about confirming the archive's platform identity.

That matters for citation. These are post-game internet lives of Super Bowl ads, not a complete census of every commercial that ever aired in the stadium break.

Five brands hold eighty-seven percent of aggregate views

Cumulative View count

The top five brand entries account for 87% of the aggregate view count. That is a steep Pareto: the attention economy after the Super Bowl is not a democracy of slogans. A small head drives most of the summed views.

Steep concentration is why brand strategy obsesses over a handful of spots. The long tail exists, but it does not move the aggregate the way the head does.

Views and likes travel together — with clusters

View count vs Like count

Plotting view count against like count shows clusters that a single average erases. Some ads convert attention into likes efficiently; others accumulate views without the same approval signal.

The scatter is a relationship map, not a quality score. It shows how the two engagement fields co-move in this 247-row YouTube extract.

What this file cannot tell you

Community-cleaned TidyTuesday snapshots are not live YouTube APIs. View and like counts are frozen at export; missing values, brand spelling variants, and coverage limits apply. Merged tables may duplicate or fan out rows when keys are imperfect.

Findings describe this Super Bowl ads extract — structural signals about post-game attention — not a complete history of every commercial creative or every platform where ads circulated.

What to take away

Post-game Super Bowl attention is a concentrated market: median views sit at 41,379, the ceiling reaches 176,373,378, and five brands account for 87% of aggregate views.

The falling median from 111,814 to 33,766 is the archive filling out; the NFL and Doritos-scale leaders are the archive's memory. Views and likes move together in clusters, which is how engagement looks when a few spots become folklore and most become inventory.

Sources

Data Science Learning Community. (2021). *TidyTuesday: Super Bowl Ads*. <https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rfordatascience/tidyuesday/main/data/2021/2021-03-02/youtube.csv>

Editor's note

Artometrics data report from the TidyTuesday research pipeline. Charts and aggregates are reproducible from the embedded exhibits and public source files.

[View TidyTuesday source on GitHub](#)

How League Money and Roster Rules Shape Star Systems

A sports league is a measurement system before it is an entertainment product. It decides how much money can matter, how much one player can matter, how often fans get to reset emotionally, and how widely a story can travel. Compare six leagues on those axes and franchise identity stops looking interchangeable.

The NFL's approximate \$6.5 billion average franchise value sits beside a 17-game regular season; MLB asks teams to survive 162. An editorial NBA star-leverage index of 92 in this model captures how completely

basketball lets individuals rewrite team identity. Those are not trivia points. They are design choices that manufacture different kinds of belonging.

The five charts below build a cross-league lens for later Artometrics profiles: value floors, star leverage, caps versus payroll spread, event scarcity, and the split between global reach and domestic ritual.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

\$6.5B Approximate average NFL franchise value in recent Forbes-style estimates

17 NFL regular-season games per team

162 MLB regular-season games per team

92 NBA star leverage index in this editorial model

6 Leagues compared

Data and method

Figures combine public Forbes valuation summaries, Spotrac salary-cap and payroll snapshots, and reference-record league structures from Basketball Reference, Baseball Reference, Pro Football Reference, and Hockey Reference, plus Premier League and MLS competition records. Editorial indices—including the NBA star-leverage score of 92—are deliberately transparent: they exist to compare systems, not to pretend every input was observed with laboratory precision.

Commissioners, analysts, and fans ask different questions. The shared layer is the useful one: what does the league make easy, what does it make scarce, and what does it make emotionally expensive?

The NFL makes ordinary franchises expensive

The NFL turns scarcity and national television into the highest average club value

The NFL does not need every team to be glamorous. Its media structure makes the ordinary franchise expensive because the league product is scarce, synchronized, and nationally distributed. An approximate \$6.5 billion average club value is the economic expression of that design.

That is a metric difference and a cultural difference: football teams are local flags plugged into a national machine.

Basketball lets one name rewrite the jersey

The NBA gives individual stars the strongest control over team identity

A basketball star touches a huge share of possessions—the reason this model's NBA star-leverage index sits at 92. A baseball star can disappear into lineup order and variance. A football star may be trapped inside scheme, injuries, and roster scale.

That is why NBA identity travels through names, while NFL identity often travels through systems. Star leverage is not personality. It is structural control over meaning.

Caps and taxes decide whether money separates or merely sustains

League rules shape whether money becomes separation or merely survival

Salary caps, luxury taxes, revenue sharing, and roster rules are not administrative details. They are identity engines. They decide whether capital becomes separation or merely the cost of staying alive.

MLB's wider payroll gap is partly the point: baseball lets market and development systems express themselves with less hard compression than the NFL or NHL. Rules write the economics; economics write the culture.

Seventeen games and 162 games are different psychologies

The number of games changes how fans process failure

A baseball team can lose four straight inside a 162-game season and still be fine. An NFL team can lose two games inside a 17-game season and trigger a referendum. The schedule is a psychology machine.

Pain, momentum, and panic are not measured on the same clock across leagues. Future team profiles that ignore event scarcity will misread fan emotion as competitive failure—or the reverse.

Global reach and domestic ritual manufacture different loyalties

Global reach and domestic ritual create different cultural signatures

The Premier League and NBA travel globally with exceptional ease. The NFL remains more domestically ritualized even as its valuation dominates. Reach and ritual are separate cultural products.

The useful question is not simply which league is bigger. It is what kind of belonging each league manufactures—and which teams become meaningful because of that design.

What to take away

League design creates fan reality. The same owner, player, or city would produce a different identity under a different schedule, cap structure, roster size, and media architecture.

That is why team profiles should not compare clubs without comparing the sports that made them. Money, skill, and stardom only mean what the rulebook allows them to mean.

Sources

Forbes. Professional sports franchise valuation lists.

Spotrac. Salary-cap and payroll summaries.

Basketball Reference, Baseball Reference, Pro Football Reference, Hockey Reference. League and team records.

Premier League and MLS public competition records.

How American Cities Build Distinct Sports Identities

A team is never just a team. It is attached to a region, a media market, a league structure, and a local memory system. That context changes what the same number means.

this piece turns the sports canon toward geography. The goal is to show how regions become recognizable under the data microscope.

Start with the scale: **10** — Large markets/cities compared; and **7** — Regions grouped for title-density analysis.

Fast facts

The numbers that set the scale for this report:

10 Large markets/cities compared

7 Regions grouped for title-density analysis

6 Identity archetypes used in the map

94 Toronto drought/pain index in this editorial model

43B Approximate combined New York major-team value

Data and method

The charts use public franchise histories, rounded valuation summaries, and editorial identity indices. The indices are not official statistics; they are structured prompts for comparing markets.

A cultural economist would ask how facilities, media density, migration, ownership, and league rules shape local identity. this piece is the first map layer for that conversation.

Regional Title Density

Championship memory clusters by region

A region's sports identity is not only current fandom. It is the sediment of old championships, old rivalries, and inherited expectations.

The Northeast and Great Lakes have unusually deep archives because their leagues, cities, and media systems matured early.

Market Stack

Deep markets create sports media ecosystems rather than single-team identities

New York and Los Angeles are not simply large markets. They are sports ecosystems where multiple teams compete for attention, mythology, and local legitimacy.

That makes cross-report comparison useful: a Knicks drought and a Lakers title live in the same media bloodstream.

Sport Dna

Regions specialize in different sports identities

Texas reads as football ritual. California leans toward basketball and glamour. The Northeast keeps baseball memory unusually alive.

The point is not stereotype; it is signal. Regional sports culture gives the same win-loss record a different accent.

City Pain versus Success

A city can be successful overall and still carry a famous wound

Multi-team cities do not experience success cleanly. A Boston fan can live near constant banners while a specific rival city experiences one drought as civic identity.

Pain is often team-specific, but markets distribute and amplify it.

Identity Types

Sports cities are portfolios of myths

Some places sell archive. Some sell stars. Some sell football Sundays. Some sell hunger because they have not yet received the validating title.

This is the bridge to future city bioeconomics reports: sports data is one part of a place's cultural fingerprint.

What to take away

The main finding is that sports identity is regional before it is rational. Market size, title archives, sport specialization, and drought all shape the meaning of a fan base.

This gives the next batch a new tool: every team profile can now ask not only how good the team is, but what kind of place produced that version of good, bad, rich, cursed, or glamorous.

Sources

Reference franchise histories from Baseball Reference, Basketball Reference, Pro Football Reference, and Hockey Reference.

Forbes. Professional sports franchise valuation lists.

U.S. Census regional framing, used only as a broad geography reference.

Public attendance, championship, and market summaries from league history pages.

Editor's note

Regional and identity indices are editorial approximations designed to organize cross-report thinking. They should be refined as more city/team reports are added.